

A Day in Macon

This moderately sized city is perfect for strolling, whether admiring the cherry blossoms, nibbling on peaches and pecans from the State Farmer's Market, or building up an appetite for the next meal.

MORNING Explore the ancient Indian mounds at the **Ocmulgee National Monument**, with structures and exhibits telling the story of 10,000 years of Southeastern Native American habitation and the distinctive Mississippian culture.

AFTERNOON Visit the **Tubman African American Museum** with its art, artifacts, cultural exhibits, and a huge mural depicting the journey from Africa to America. Cross the road to the exhibits of music and memorabilia in the **Georgia Music Hall of Fame**, then wander down to the river where a statue of Otis Redding gleams in the sun.

EVENING Take the self-guided Lights on Macon walking tour of the **Historic District** to see grand antebellum houses, such as magnificent Hay House ("Palace of the South"), and the pretty Lee Alumni House, with its archetypal southern verandas, lit up in all their glory.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

The closest **international airport** is Hartsfield-Jackson Atlanta, 80 miles (130 km) away. There are some commuter flights to **Middle Georgia Regional Airport**, 10 miles (16 km) from Macon. Renting a **car** is recommended.

WHERE TO STAY

Ramada Plaza (inexpensive) has a pool and is a short walk from the Georgia Music Hall of Fame. www.ramada.com

Marriott Macon City Center (moderate) is conveniently located for the downtown historic sites. www.marriott.com/mcnfs

1842 Inn (expensive) has romantic rooms in an antebellum mansion. www.1842inn.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

Downtown Visitors Center, 450 Martin Luther King, Jr. Blvd; www.maconga.org



Right Crispy southern-fried chicken uses crushed crackers or even cornflakes for the crunchy coating

Below The thousands of Yoshino cherry trees that line Macon's streets are a froth of white blossoms in March

